

User guide to the Inventory Management GUI tool

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BIG NOTE: All software created by Brian is a work-in-progress. If something doesn't work as desired or crashes when operating as-expected, report it so a fix can be worked out.

Limitations

This tool can only work with certain types of data. In this case, a container **MUST** be assigned to a location. Containers not assigned to a location will not show up in the ArchivesSpace report being relied upon (location holdings report). All containers *should* be assigned to a location if other procedures are being followed.

Preliminary steps (Run/Location Location Holdings Report)

You **MUST** have a location holdings report available for this tool to work. In its native export format, the report will have a filename like so:

`job_[job number]_location_holdings_report_[date ran].csv`

if a location holdings report is not available, run the report or have someone able to do so run it for you. To run the report do the following:

1. In the main ArchivesSpace task bar, click on Create, then Background Job at the bottom of the drop-down menu, then Create Report in the side menu.
2. Scroll down to Location Holdings or use left sidebar navigation to hotlink to it. Click on the Select button.
3. In the subsequent screen choose the Locations as by Repository, and select the corresponding repository, then choose the CSV format. DO NOT check the Linked Records in JSON option. Click on start job. Like shown below.

New Background Job — Create Report Background Job

Location Holdings Exit

Report on containers shelved at one or more locations:

Locations:

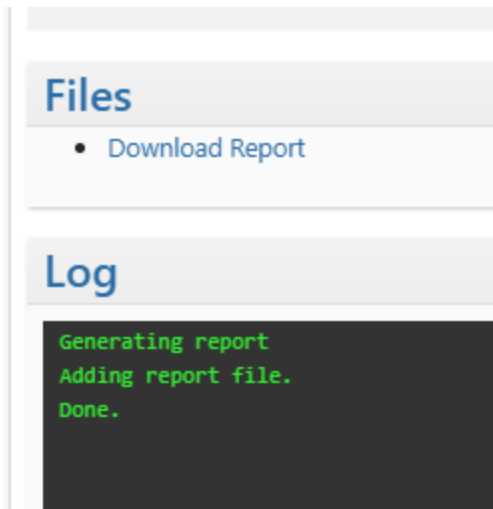
Repository:

Format:

Linked Records in JSON ☐

Start Job Cancel

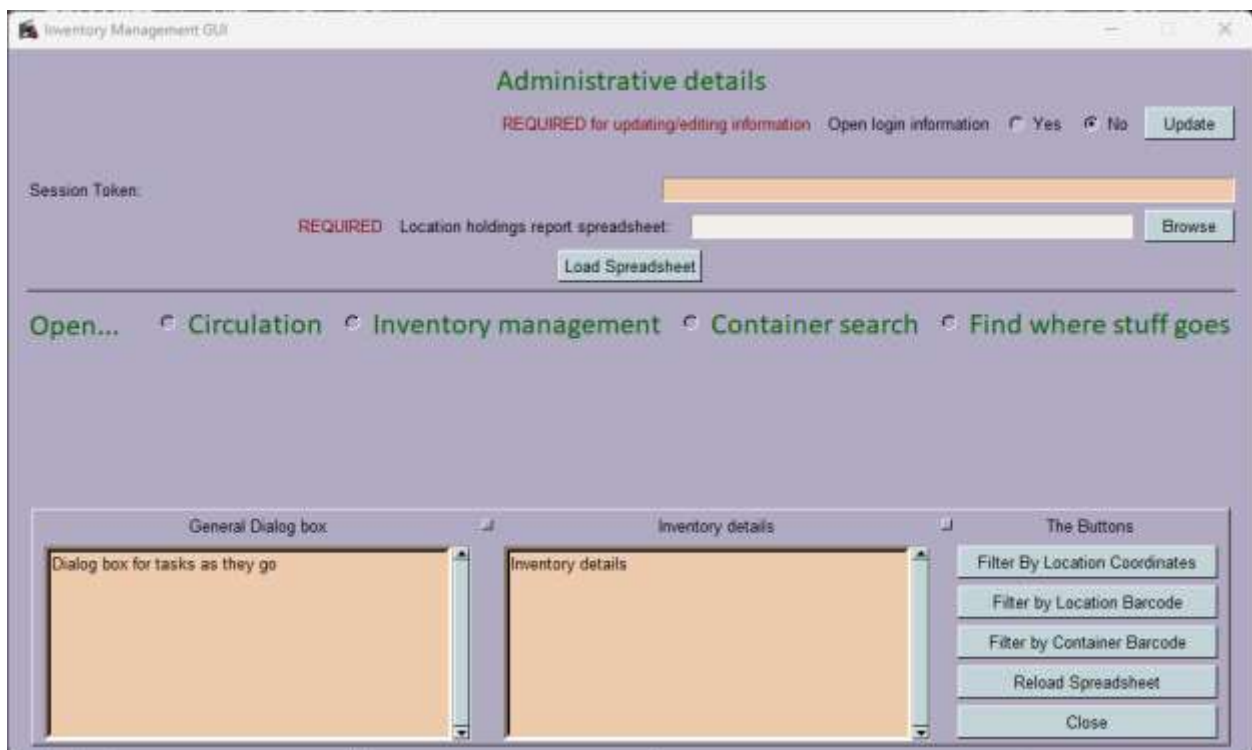
4. Wait for the background job to complete then click on the download link.



NOTE as well: the tool will make changes to the location holdings report csv depending on the other actions you take so DON'T have it open in MS Excel when you are working with it.

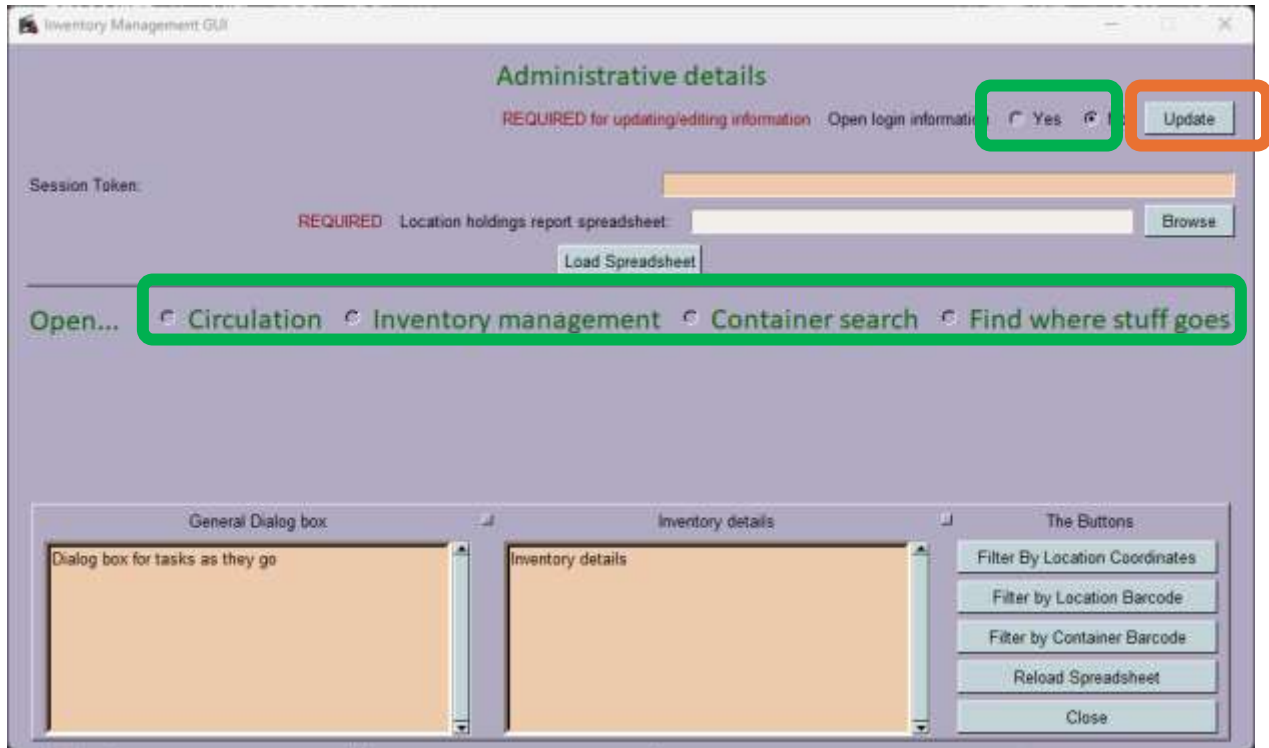
Navigating the tool

Due to the many semi-related functions being requested as part of the tool, including all aspects of the tool in a single window while still making it usable was not feasible. Administrative details, the dialog boxes and the buttons are common across all aspects so they will always be available.



Appearing/disappearing sections

Checkboxes and radio buttons are meant to expand/contract/reveal parts of the tool. This action should be triggered automatically on selection. If does not, use the Update button on the upper right-hand part of the interface to trigger the action.



Update button is highlighted in orange and preliminary radio buttons are highlighted in green

Shown below is the before/after of an expanding section triggered by a checkbox. Note that checkboxes are contextual so not all checkboxes will reveal additional sections.

Inventory Management GUI

Administrative details

REQUIRED for updating/editing information Open login information ☒ Yes ☐ No

ArchivesSpace API address:

ArchivesSpace username:

ArchivesSpace password:

Session Token:

REQUIRED Location holdings report spreadsheet:

Open... ☒ Circulation ☒ **Inventory management** ☐ Container search ☐ Find where stuff goes

For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room: Floor: Room:

☐ Inventory range check Range: Section: Shelf:

General Dialog box

Dialog box for tasks as they go

Inventory details

Inventory details

The Buttons

After checking the Inventory range check checkbox.

The screenshot shows the 'Inventory Management GUI' window. The title bar includes a small icon and the text 'Inventory Management GUI'. The main content area is titled 'Administrative details' in green. Below this, there's a red text label 'REQUIRED for updating/editing information' followed by 'Open login information' with radio buttons for 'Yes' (selected) and 'No', and an 'Update' button. There are three input fields: 'ArchivesSpace API address:' with a placeholder 'enter api address here', 'ArchivesSpace username:', and 'ArchivesSpace password:'. A 'Test Login' button is to the right of the password field. Below these is a 'Session Token:' label and a long orange bar. Further down, a red text label 'REQUIRED' is followed by 'Location holdings report spreadsheet:' and a 'Browse' button. A 'Load Spreadsheet' button is centered below. A horizontal menu bar contains 'Open...', 'Circulation', 'Inventory management' (selected), 'Container search', and 'Find where stuff goes'. Below the menu, a red text label says 'For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room'. There are dropdowns for 'Range start', 'Floor', 'Room', 'Range', 'Section', and 'Shelf'. A checked checkbox 'Inventory range check' is present. There are also 'Whole room' and 'Generate Shelf list' buttons. Below these are checkboxes for 'Also generate PDF' and 'Also generate spreadsheet'. A red text label explains: 'Inventory range uses auto incrementing and cannot handle large numbers or text by default, include options below include EVERYTHING of that type Use Include Bonus for Bonus shelving. Include North/South/East/West for ranges against walls. Include atypical to include locations'. There are checkboxes for 'Include Bonus shelving', 'Include North/South/East/West', and 'Include atypical'. A 'Needed linear inches:' input field is followed by 'Calculate available Storage' and 'Find me storage' buttons. At the bottom, there are three panels: 'General Dialog box' (containing 'Dialog box for tasks as they go'), 'Inventory details' (containing 'Inventory details'), and 'The Buttons' (containing 'Filter By Location Coordinates', 'Filter by Location Barcode', 'Filter by Container Barcode', 'Reload Spreadsheet', and 'Close' buttons).

Sticky buttons/checkboxes/radio buttons

A quirk of the program used to compile the interface is that some things don't respond on the first attempt to select them. This is more often the case with buttons but can be any of the above listed things. If a thing doesn't respond give the tool a second to ensure it isn't running slow. If that does not help, click on a different part of the interface and then click on your selected again. This may take several attempts but should work.

Read-only vs. Data entry fields

Some parts of the interface are meant to be read-only whereas others are intended for possible data entry. A field will be, or should be, read-only if its background color is peach. Data entry fields have a white background.

Dialog boxes

There are two dialog boxes: The general dialog box and the Inventory details dialog box located at the bottom of the window.

The screenshot displays the 'Inventory Management GUI' window. The main area is titled 'Administrative details' and contains several input fields and buttons. At the bottom, two dialog boxes are visible: 'General Dialog box' and 'Inventory details'. The 'General Dialog box' contains the text 'Dialog box for tasks as they go spreadsheet loaded'. The 'Inventory details' dialog box is empty. To the right of the dialog boxes is a section titled 'The Buttons' containing five buttons: 'Filter By Location Coordinates', 'Filter by Location Barcode', 'Filter by Container Barcode', 'Reload Spreadsheet', and 'Close'.

Inventory Management GUI

Administrative details

REQUIRED for updating/editing information Open login information ☒ Yes ☐ No Update

ArchivesSpace API address: enter api address here

ArchivesSpace username:

ArchivesSpace password:

Test Login

Session Token:

REQUIRED Location holdings report spreadsheet: F:/Archives/Collections_management/Locations/FY2026 Sta Browse

Load Spreadsheet

Open... ☒ Circulation ☐ Inventory management ☐ Container search ☐ Find where stuff goes

☐ Enable edit

Location URI:

Location Profile:

Location barcode:

Containers at location: Container barcode:

For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room Floor: Room:

Range: Section: Shelf:

General Dialog box

Inventory details

The Buttons

Filter By Location Coordinates

Filter by Location Barcode

Filter by Container Barcode

Reload Spreadsheet

Close

The general dialog box will:

- Provide status messages about steps in a current task
- Provide status messages when a task is completed
- Give samples of raw data

The Inventory details dialog box will:

- Provide information about containers to be found on a specific shelf once that shelf has been identified.
- Provide very granular information output from a task

Drop-down options

There are a handful of situations where a drop-down list of options is necessary. Drop-down by default are only populated when data is loaded. Selecting a value from a drop-down will not necessarily result in an automatic change to other data points so it is important to press a corresponding button to act on the drop-down selection.

Inventory Management GUI

Administrative details

REQUIRED for updating/editing information Open login information ☒ Yes ☐ No

ArchivesSpace API address: enter api address here

ArchivesSpace username:

ArchivesSpace password:

Session Token:

REQUIRED Location holdings report spreadsheet: F:/Archives/Collections_management/Locations/FY2026 Sta

Open... ☒ Circulation ☒ Inventory management ☐ Container search ☐ Find where stuff goes

☐ Enable edit

Location URI:

Location Profile:

Location barcode:

Containers at location:

For working with location coordinates: first filter by Floor/Room Floor: 5th Stack Room:

Range: Section: Shelf:

1st Stack
2nd Stack
306
328
4th Stack
5th Stack
6th Stack
7th Stack

General Dialog box: Dialog box for tasks as they go spreadsheet loaded

Inventory details:

The Button: Filter By Location C6G17

Filter by Location Barcode

Filter by Container Barcode

Reload Spreadsheet

Close

Administrative details section

Required actions (load dataspreadsheet)

In all circumstances you **MUST** load a locations holding report spreadsheet into the program.

REQUIRED Location holdings report spreadsheet:

To do this, in the Administrative details section:

1. Click on Browse and navigate to the locations holding report
2. Click on the Load Spreadsheet button.
 - a. If successful a spreadsheet loaded message should show up in the General Dialog box.

NOTE: prior to doing this required action you will need to have a copy of the locations holding report.

Optional actions (login to make edits)

In circumstances where you want to enact a change to data (check-in boxes, update barcodes, etc.) it is necessary to log into the ArchivesSpace API. During the later action it is possible that the tool will log in again, but you need to login initially to verify your credentials are in the tool and correct.

Administrative details

REQUIRED for updating/editing information Open login information ☒ Yes ☐ No

ArchivesSpace API address:

ArchivesSpace username:

ArchivesSpace password:

9c240b4d8f727e7a469fe1139f66f0c123e193361d5650ec8015574b63c397e0

To perform an initial login to the ArchivesSpace API, in the Administrative details section:

1. Select the Yes radio button next to Open login information. If the login section does not automatically appear, click on the Update button.
2. Enter the ArchivesSpace API address. If this is a TSLAC employee the API address is as shown above. Others will have their own local or hosted url.
3. Enter your username (not email unless that incidentally is your username) and password.
4. Press the Test Login button
 - a. If successful the read-only Session Token field should show something like seen above.

- b. If successful your user information will populate in the General Dialog box. It will list all of the permissions you have for each repository.
5. Once logged in successfully you can check the No radio button next to Open login information to contract the section. The login details will remain in the program.

NOTE: you can log into the API regardless of your user status so it is important to ensure you have the relevant permissions to make changes. These should be (1) update/manage top-containers, and (2) update/manage locations.

Circulation

The circulation function is meant to facilitate transfer of top containers from one location to another. It is meant to be run using a barcode scanner but competent typing skills may suffice if not available.

To access this function, select the Circulation radio button on the lower section of the tool. It will look like what is shown below.



The screenshot shows a software interface with a purple header bar. In the header, there are five radio buttons: "Open...", "Circulation" (which is selected), "Inventory management", "Container search", and "Find where stuff goes". Below the header, on the right side, there are four more radio buttons: "Checkout to reference", "Checkout", "Return", and "Transfer". Below these are two input fields: "Container barcode:" and "Location barcode:". At the bottom right, there is a green button labeled "Circulate Container".

Pre-requisites

The following are needed for circulation to work:

- Loaded location holdings report (see Administrative details section)
- API login (see Administrative details section). You *must* test your login to ensure it is working correctly.
- **BARCODES.** Barcodes must already be assigned to the container and the target location.

Running it

To run this function once revealed:

1. Select the check-out type radio button that closest matches your circumstances
 - a. Use "Checkout to reference" for reference check-outs
 - b. Use "Checkout" to check out to a different party
 - c. Use "Return" to put the container back at the originating stacks location from a checkout

- d. Use “Transfer” to move the container to a new location within the stacks
2. In the Container barcode field scan in the barcode associated with the container
3. In the Location barcode field scan in the barcode associated with the location
4. Click on Circulate Container. Wait for a sec for the process to complete.

Under the hood

When clicking on circulate container, the tool is

- using the barcode of the location to pull up the UUID for the target location from the location holdings report
- logging into the ArchivesSpace API to get the container raw data using the barcode search functionality
- processing that data for manipulation.
 - If Checkout to reference was selected a second location specific to reference is added to the locations and an internal note added to the primary location that the box is checked out to reference.
 - If Checkout was selected a second location specific to the new location is added to the locations for the container and an internal note added to the primary location that the box is checked out to the new location.
 - If Return is selected, the second location (checkout to location) is removed from the container and a internal added to the remaining location that the box was returned.
 - If Transfer is selected the original location is replaced with the new location and an internal note added that the box was transferred to the new location.
- Posting an update to ArchivesSpace with the processed data.

Inventory management

Inventory management is meant to get a listing of boxes at a particular range of locations. It relies on a shared field with the Find where stuff goes function, so when activating it make sure to also click on the Inventory range check checkbox to reveal all functionality.

Pre-requisites

You **MUST** load a location holdings report for this to work. If you were working with another function it would be a good idea to reload the spreadsheet by either clicking the Load Spreadsheet button above or the Reload Spreadsheet button next to the Inventory details dialog box.

Step 1: First step (narrow parameters)

The drop-down options for the Floor/Room/Range/Section/Shelf are loaded directly from a filtered subset of the location holdings report. If a filter is not applied first by selecting a Floor and Room no filter is applied and available options for the other drop-downs represent every possible combination for the stacks. Including contradictory options that will crash the program.

If you need to change the Floor/Room, it is necessary to reload the spreadsheet to reset all values. You may need to hit reload twice.

NOTE ABOUT GROUND and FIRST floors: there are multiple rooms with applicable storage options on the Ground floor and first floor. All stacks corresponding to the East side of the Zavala building are located in “Stack” options.

1. Select the appropriate floor from the Floor drop-down menu
2. Select the appropriate room from the Room drop-down menu
3. Click on the “Filter By Location Coordinates” button. All other drop-down values should update to only the applicable options.

Step 2: Choose your ranges

NOTE: If opting to look at a whole floor instead of a range of shelves, click on the “Whole room” checkbox next to the “Generate Shelf list” button. Checking this box will override any range choices or Include checkboxes.

NOTE: the inventory management functionality works on an iterative process (auto-incrementing) to capture data. This means that it cannot jump from numbered ranges to non-numbered ranges, or from one type of directional range to another (i.e. from North to South).

1. Select a beginning range, then section, then shelf from the first row next to the Inventory range check checkbox.
2. Select an ending range, then section, then shelf from next to the General Shelf list button.
 - a. If choosing a starting range that is directional, the ending range must be the same direction.
 - b. Ensure that the range, section, and shelf represent a location greater than or equal to the starting range.

Step 3: Additional options to include

When running a shelf list against a numerical range Bonus shelving, directional shelving, and atypical shelving (very large numbers such as the map drawers or deep shelving) don't get included by default for technical reasons.

To include these types of shelving check the box next to the ones you want included. It will include **all** of the applicable type of thing.

Inventory range uses auto incrementing and cannot handle large numbers or text by default. include options below include EVERYTHING of that type
Use Include Bonus for Bonus shelving. Include North/South/East/West for ranges against walls. Include 'atypical' to include locations

☐ Include Bonus shelving ☐ Include North/South/East/West ☐ Include atypical

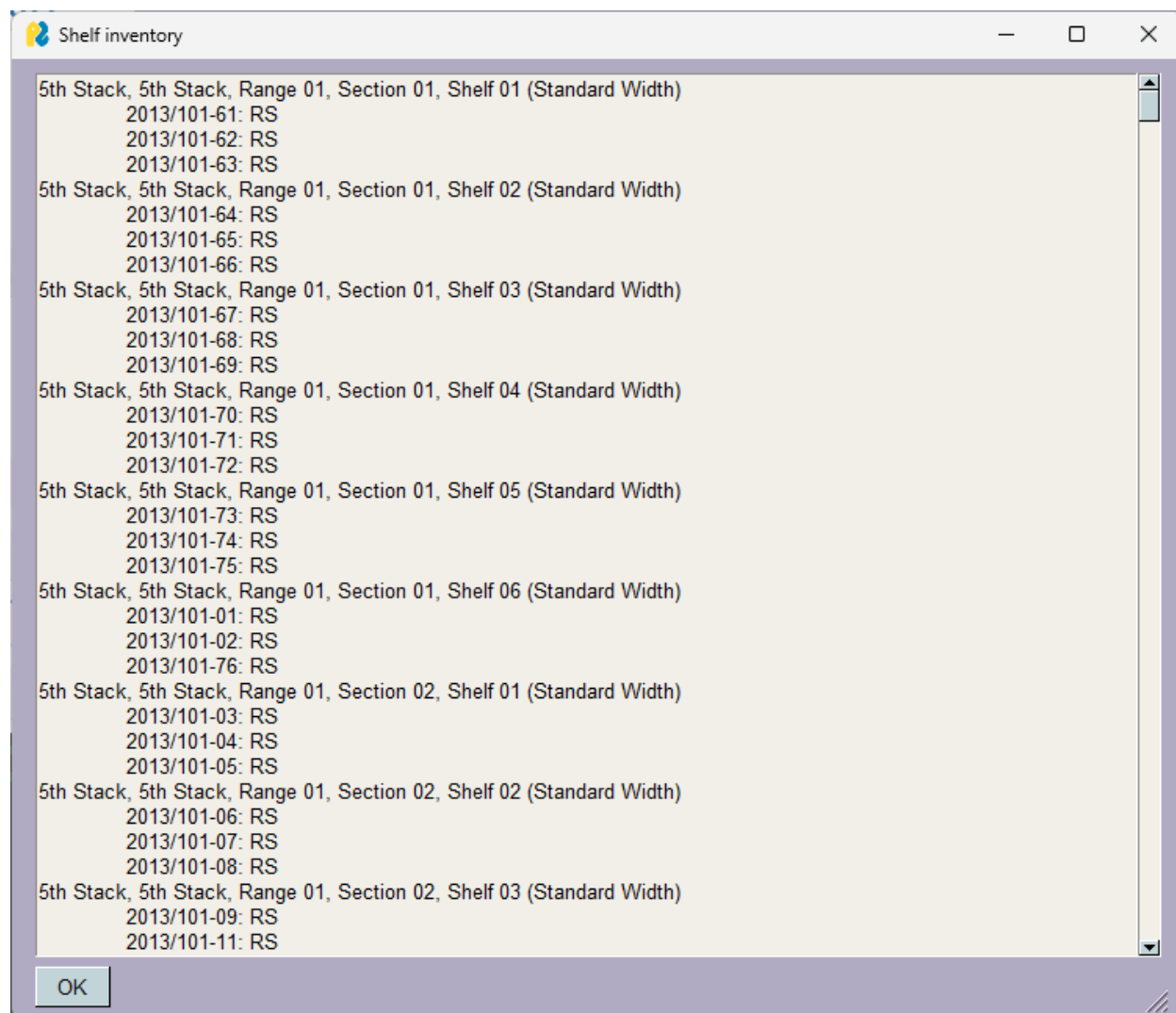
If generating a shelf list, the default output is a pop-up window you can then copy data into a text editor for. If you wish, you can choose to also have a PDF version of the pop-up window data or a spreadsheet table version of the filtered data to work with.

Check the options you wish to apply. You can check both or neither.

☐ Also generate PDF ☐ Also generate spreadsheet

Reporting option 1: Generate Shelf list

After selecting the parts you want included in your shelf list in steps 1 thru 3, click on the Generate Shelf list button. Once it runs (assuming no errors), a pop-up will appear with the requested details, like so:



Clicking on OK will close the window. To work with the data in this format, you can copy/paste the data into a text editor such as notepad++. To do this click into the window, press ctrl+a to select all, then ctrl+c to copy to clipboard, finally open the target location and press ctrl+v to paste the data in.

Be aware that the text of this pop-up window is editable, take care with keystrokes when copying and pasting your data.

If you chose to also generate a PDF or spreadsheet a file will now exist at the location of the inventory tool executable. The filename will look like inventory _of_[room].[pdf or xlsx]

 inventory_of_5th Stack.pdf

 inventory_of_5th Stack.xlsx

The PDF output is an exact duplicate of the pop-up window data with a few indent formatting quirks. Like so:

Shelf list

5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 01 (Standard Width)

2013/101-61: RS

2013/101-62: RS

2013/101-63: RS

5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 02 (Standard Width)

2013/101-64: RS

2013/101-65: RS

2013/101-66: RS

5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 03 (Standard Width)

2013/101-67: RS

2013/101-68: RS

2013/101-69: RS

5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 04 (Standard Width)

2013/101-70: RS

2013/101-71: RS

2013/101-72: RS

5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 05 (Standard Width)

2013/101-73: RS

2013/101-74: RS

2013/101-75: RS

The spreadsheet output assumes a shelf-reading project so columns exist for present/missing checks, the box name, the shelf coordinates. Like shown below.

1	in stacks	missing	coordinat	shelf type	container	container	container type
2			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
3			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
4			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
5			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
6			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
7			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
8			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
9			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
10			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
11			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
12			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
13			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
14			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
15			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
16			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
17			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
18			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
19			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS
20			5th Stack,	Standard	2013/101-	no value	RS

For readability and better use, it is recommended to select the data in the spreadsheet and create a table out of it. Like shown below.

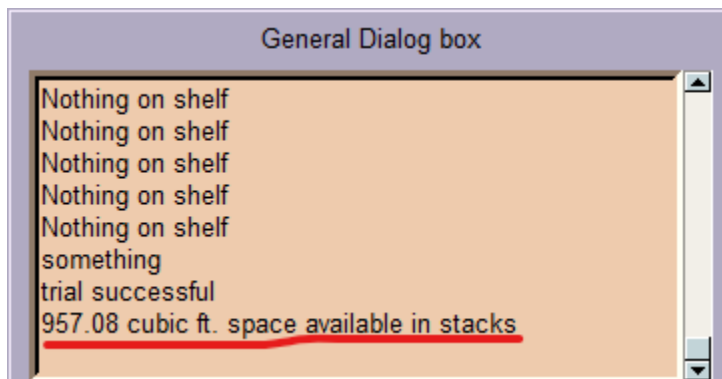
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	in stacks	missing	coordinates	shelf type	containers	container barcode	container type
2			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 01	Standard Width	2013/101-61	no value	RS
3			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 01	Standard Width	2013/101-62	no value	RS
4			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 01	Standard Width	2013/101-63	no value	RS
5			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 02	Standard Width	2013/101-64	no value	RS
6			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 02	Standard Width	2013/101-65	no value	RS
7			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 02	Standard Width	2013/101-66	no value	RS
8			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 03	Standard Width	2013/101-67	no value	RS
9			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 03	Standard Width	2013/101-68	no value	RS
10			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 03	Standard Width	2013/101-69	no value	RS
11			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 04	Standard Width	2013/101-70	no value	RS
12			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 04	Standard Width	2013/101-71	no value	RS
13			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 04	Standard Width	2013/101-72	no value	RS
14			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 05	Standard Width	2013/101-73	no value	RS
15			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 05	Standard Width	2013/101-74	no value	RS
16			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 05	Standard Width	2013/101-75	no value	RS
17			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 06	Standard Width	2013/101-01	no value	RS
18			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 06	Standard Width	2013/101-02	no value	RS
19			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 06	Standard Width	2013/101-76	no value	RS
20			5th Stack, 5th Stack, Range 01, Section 02, Shelf 01	Standard Width	2013/101-03	no value	RS

Reporting option 2: Calculate available storage

Pressing the Calculate available Storage button will iterate over the selection from Steps 1 thru 3 and do the math to determine how much free space is available in those ranges on a linear inches basis.

This math is only as good as the data in ArchivesSpace so a mismatch in container type or rough dimensions of a container will affect the output.

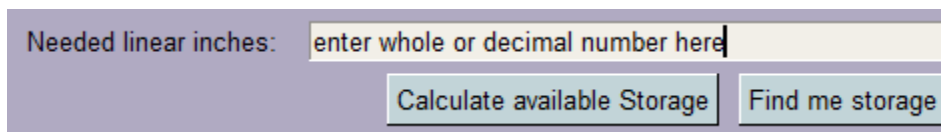
To run this report click on the Calculate available Storage. Once the math is completed it will give the output in the General Dialog box.



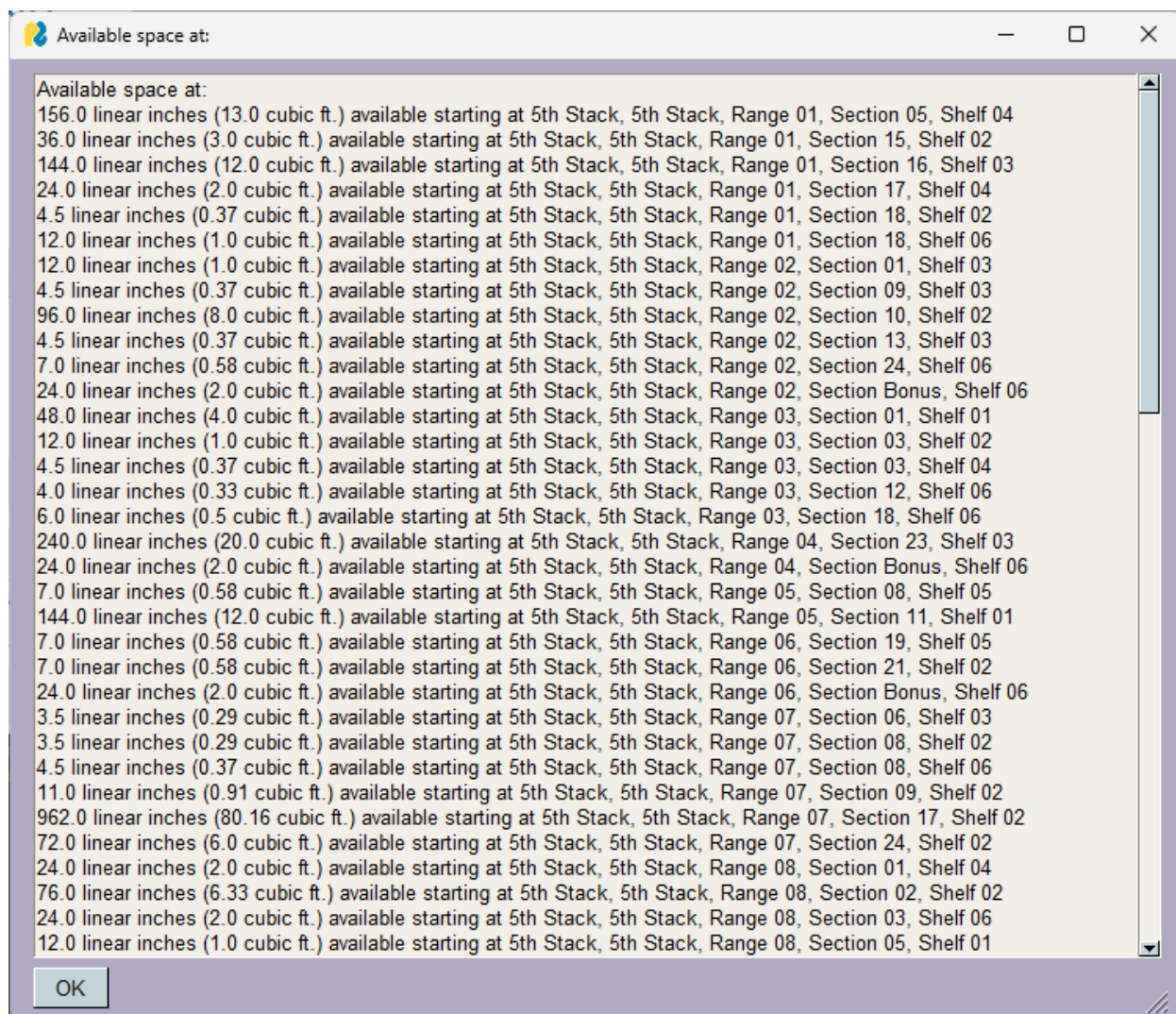
Reporting option 3: Find available storage

This reporting option is meant to help find potential places to put boxes as a set. Everything is assumed as one shelf of depth so enter the linear width using the following rules of thumb.

- LittleMS = 2.5
- MS = 5
- RS = 12
- OS = see the container profile for width information
- If you know the cubic feet but not the container counts, multiply cubic feet by 12.

A screenshot of a software interface for the "Find available storage" tool. It features a label "Needed linear inches:" followed by a text input field containing the placeholder text "enter whole or decimal number here". Below the input field are two buttons: "Calculate available Storage" and "Find me storage".

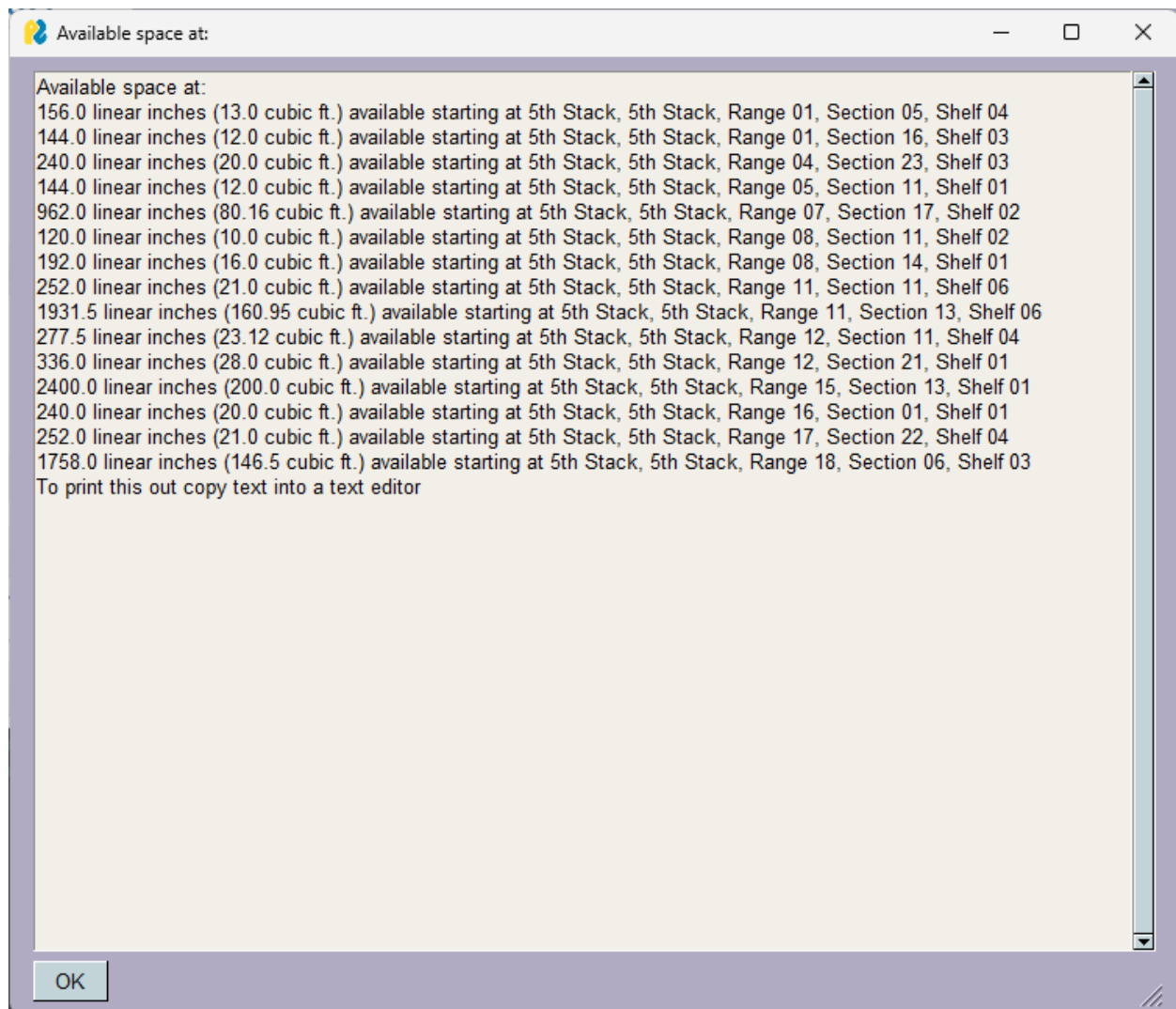
Once you enter the whole or decimal number, click on "Find me storage" to run the tool. The output will be a pop-up window with a listing of available options. Like shown below.



To get values the tool iterates over the applicable ranges, measures the contiguous available width from shelf with empty space X to shelf with empty space Y, skips over places where there is less than 2.5 inches of available space, and reports back the results.

NOTE this means if there are a set of partially empty shelves back-to-back, it will report that as available contiguous space.

The above report is based on a single LittleMS box, contrast those results against needing 100 linear inches as shown below.



Container search

Container search is meant to verify the stacks locations of a set of things based on a call number (accession number or prefix), or TX number. The general use case is wrapping up accession documentation or a finding aid and needing the verify everything is where is supposed to be in the stacks. Since TX numbers are only associated with containers in ArchivesSpace when there is a finding aid in existence, both options are provided.

The search is conducted across the entire location holdings report.

Open... ☐ Circulation ☒ Inventory management ☒ Container search ☐ Find where stuff goes

Search by prefix (i.e.: 2013/002 or 2-22/ Find me

Search by TX# Find me

Option 1: Search by prefix

- Enter the prefix or call number of the container in the top row
- Click on the top Find me button to execute.

A pop-up window will appear showing location data, call number, and container type for each match. Like shown below.

Container inventory

7th Stack, Range 07, Section 03, Shelf 02 (Tall Volume Standard)
2-22/099: Volume

7th Stack, Range 08, Section 14, Shelf 02 (Tall Volume Narrow)
2-22/001: Volume
2-22/002: Volume
2-22/003: Volume
2-22/004: Volume
2-22/005: Volume
2-22/006: Volume
2-22/007: Volume
2-22/008: Volume
2-22/009: Volume
2-22/010: Volume
2-22/011: Volume
2-22/012: Volume
2-22/013: Volume
2-22/014: Volume
2-22/015: Volume

7th Stack, Range 08, Section 14, Shelf 03 (Tall Volume Narrow)
2-22/016: Volume
2-22/017: Volume
2-22/018: Volume
2-22/019: Volume
2-22/020: Volume
2-22/021: Volume
2-22/022: Volume
2-22/023: Volume
2-22/024: Volume
2-22/025: Volume
2-22/026: Volume
2-22/027: Volume
2-22/028: Volume
2-22/029: Volume
2-22/030: Volume

7th Stack, Range 08, Section 15, Shelf 01 (Tall Volume Narrow)

OK

NOTE: This option works by matching the characters entered with beginning of the container name in the location holdings report. This means that the longer the character string the narrower the results. For example, in accession 2030/002 with 1600 boxes entering the following will yield the specified results:

- 2030/002: 1600 containers
- 2030/002-0: 999 containers
- 2030/002-00: 99 containers
- 2030/002-000: 9 containers (containers always start at 1 not 0)
- 2030/002-001: 10 containers

Find where stuff goes

Find where stuff goes is the original and also the most complex functionality. Originally designed to be able to shelf read and update information by pulling up data shelf-by-shelf, it has been repurposed to do a number of additional tasks. It can be used to :

- Pull up the container data for everything on a specific shelf
- Find the shelf location for a container by barcode
- Add barcode data to a container located on a specific shelf
- Find the container data and other information for a location by barcode
- Add barcode data to a specific location
- Update/add location profiles for a location

Pre-requisites

To use any functionality you must:

- Load a location holdings report.
- To reset the data you are working with, click on Reload Spreadsheet or Load Spreadsheet.

To use update functionality, you must:

- Have the appropriate permissions and log into the ArchivesSpace API . see Administrative details section for how to do this.

NOTE that edit/update functionality is protected by an Enable edit checkbox to prevent accidental updates. Be cautious when Enable edit is checked.

Filter by container barcode

This function is intended to help you find where to return a container to after its been used for whatever purpose. Once you know where the container goes you can use the circulation functionality to check the container back into where it is supposed to be.

To use this function, first load or reload the location holdings report. Then

1. Click into the container barcode data field
2. Use a barcode scanner to scan the container barcode into this field or manually type it in
3. Click on the Filter by Container Barcode button in the “The Buttons” section

The result will show in the Inventory details dialog box with the stacks location the container belongs to. See below screenshot.

The screenshot displays the 'Inventory management' section of a library management system. At the top, there are tabs for 'Open...', 'Circulation', 'Inventory management', 'Container search', and 'Find where stuff goes'. Below these, there are fields for 'Location URI' (set to '/locations/1578') and 'Location Profile'. A red arrow points to the 'Container barcode' field, which contains the text 'anothercontainerbarcode'. To the right of this field is a red arrow pointing to the 'Filter by Container Barcode' button in the 'The Buttons' section. The 'Inventory details' section shows a message: 'Box 401-0002 should be located at Zavala, 1st Stack, 1st Stack, Range 01, Section 01, Shelf 01'. The 'General Dialog box' on the left shows a log of spreadsheet loading and filtering actions.

Filter by Location Barcode

This is meant to shortcut the filtering down to a shelf to see what belongs there by leveraging the location barcode. The main use case is being at a shelf and not sure what is supposed to be there, having the ability to be most accurate in looking up the shelf by using a location barcode, and pulling up that data. To run this functionality

1. Reset all options by reloading the location holdings report
2. Click into the Location barcode data field
3. Using a barcode scanner scan in the location barcode or manually type it in
4. Click on the Filter by Location Barcode button

Any containers at the location will show in the Inventory details dialog box. “no value” indicates there is nothing at that location. See screenshot below.

The screenshot shows the 'Inventory management' tab in a software interface. At the top, there are navigation tabs: 'Open...', 'Circulation', 'Inventory management' (selected), 'Container search', and 'Find where stuff goes'. Below these, there's a section for location information. 'Location URI' is set to '/locations/23985'. 'Location Profile' is empty. 'Location barcode' is 'ZAVREFERENCE', with a red arrow pointing to it. 'Containers at location' is empty. 'Container barcode' is empty. There are buttons for 'Update location profile', 'Update location barcode', and 'Update container barcode'. Below these, there's a red text提示: 'For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room'. There are also dropdowns for 'Floor', 'Room', 'Range', 'Section', and 'Shelf'. At the bottom, there's a 'General Dialog box' with a log of actions: 'spreadsheet loaded', 'filtered down to 3555 shelves', 'continue filtering down', 'jackpot', 'spreadsheet loaded', '533 rows', 'spreadsheet loaded', 'jackpot'. To the right of the log is the 'Inventory details' dialog box, which shows 'no value: barcode no value' with a red arrow pointing to it. To the right of the 'Inventory details' dialog box is a section titled 'The Buttons' with buttons for 'Filter By Location Coordinates', 'Filter by Location Barcode', 'Filter by Container Barcode', 'Reload Spreadsheet', and 'Close'.

Filter by Location Coordinates

This is meant to pull location inventory details when you either have no location barcode or can't scan it. This is a multiple-step process.

1. Reset all options by reloading the location holdings report. You may have to click the button multiple times, but the width of the various drop-downs will expand once reloaded.
2. First select the Floor and Room from the drop-down options and Click on the Filter by Location Coordinates button. Like seen below.

Open... Circulation Inventory management Container search Find where stuff goes

☐ Enable edit

Location URI:

Location Profile:

Location barcode:

Containers at location: Container barcode:

For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room

Floor: Room:

Range: Section: Shelf:

General Dialog box: filtered down to 3555 shelves
continue filtering down

Inventory details: no value: barcode no value

The Buttons: Filter By Location Coordinates

The drop-down options for Range/Section/Shelf will update with step 2 to just those applicable to floor/room combination chosen. The General Dialog Box will also show a status message of how many shelves are applicable to your filter at this point.

- Continue filtering down by Range/Section/Shelf until you reach a single shelf. When that happens the Inventory details dialog box will update with the identifiers for the boxes found at those locations. The Containers at location drop-down will also be populated. Like seen below.

Open... Circulation Inventory management Container search Find where stuff goes

☐ Enable edit

Location URI:

Location Profile:

Location barcode:

Containers at location: Container barcode:

For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room

Floor: Room:

Range: Section: Shelf:

General Dialog box: spreadsheet loaded
jackpot
spreadsheet loaded
filtered down to 3555 shelves
continue filtering down

Inventory details: 2014/015-2: barcode no value
2014/015-3: barcode no value

The Buttons: Filter By Location Coordinates
Filter by Location Barcode
Filter by Container Barcode

Fields associated with the location which have existing values will be marked read-only with a peach colored background. Fields where you can enter data will be in white.

Updating/adding data

This tool is written to ensure that any updates are made with intention rather than on accident. Individual update functions are listed below.

In addition to the Required and optional actions under the Administrative details section, you will need to click the Enable edit checkbox to get access to the update buttons.

Open... Circulation Inventory management Container search Find where stuff goes

Location URI:

Location Profile:

Location barcode:

Containers at location: Container barcode:

For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room Floor: Room:

Range: Section: Shelf:

☐ Enable edit

When doing so, the interface will reconfigure to what you see below.

Open... Circulation Inventory management Container search Find where stuff goes

Location URI:

Location Profile:

Location barcode:

Containers at location: Container barcode:

For working with location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room Floor: Room:

Range: Section: Shelf:

☒ Enable edit

Update location profile

Update location barcode

Update container barcode

Add barcode to container

First you will, you will need to follow the preliminary steps of:

1. Log into the ArchivesSpace API
2. Load/Reload the location holdings report spreadsheet
3. Check the Enable edit checkbox to reveal the update buttons
4. Have a barcode scanner ready and paired with your computer

Now:

- Locate the exact container you wish to deal with by filtering by location coordinates or location barcode. This will give you a drop-down list of containers to work with like shown below.

Containers at location: 2010/066-215
2024/051-1

Location barcode: no value

Container barcode:

Location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room Floor: 5th Stack Room: 5th Stack
Range: Range 20 Section: Section 20 Shelf: Shelf 06

Update location profile
Update location barcode
Update container barcode

- Select the container to assign a barcode to. Note that any container already assigned a barcode will be marked read-only with a peach-colored background.

Containers at location: 2010/066-215

Location barcode: no value

Container barcode: 001196962

Location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room Floor: 5th Stack Room: 5th Stack
Range: Range 20 Section: Section 20 Shelf: Shelf 06

Update location profile
Update location barcode
Update container barcode

Read-only barcode field

Containers at location: 2024/051-1

Location barcode: no value

Container barcode: no value

Location coordinates, first filter by Floor/Room Floor: 5th Stack Room: 5th Stack
Range: Range 20 Section: Section 20 Shelf: Shelf 06

Update location profile
Update location barcode
Update container barcode

Editable barcode field

- Click into the Container barcode field. Remove the “no value” placeholder
- Scan in the barcode using the barcode scanner or manually key it in
- Click on the Update container barcode button
- Once the update action has been completed you will get an “update completed” message in the General Dialog box. The Container barcode field doesn’t automatically become read-only but will show as read only if you reload the report.

Notes about running in bulk and general cautions

1. There is no bulk edit mode. You will have to select each container individually.
2. If you are attaching the barcode sticker at the same time, make sure the barcode sticker is on first and won’t fall off before you scan
3. You can functionally run this in bulk by going shelf-by-shelf attaching stickers and scanning barcodes.
4. You need to have an internet connection for this to function because it works by
 - a. accessing the ArchivesSpace API,
 - b. downloading the container data,
 - c. adding the barcode field with barcode number to the data,
 - d. pushing the update back to ArchivesSpace,
 - e. adding the barcode data to the location holdings report and saving it

Add barcode to location

First you will, you will need to follow the preliminary steps of:

1. Log into the ArchivesSpace API
2. Load/Reload the location holdings report spreadsheet
3. Check the Enable edit checkbox to reveal the update buttons
4. Have a barcode scanner ready and paired with your computer

Now:

- Use the filter by location coordinates functionality described above until you reach a single location (shelf). If a location barcode is already assigned the Location barcode field will be marked read-only with a peach-colored background.
- Click into the Location barcode field. Remove the “no value” placeholder
- Scan in the barcode using the barcode scanner or manually keying it in
- Click on the Update location barcode button
- Once the update action has been completed you will get an “update completed” message in the General Dialog box. The Location barcode field doesn’t automatically become read-only but will show as read-only if you reload the report.

Notes about running in bulk and general cautions

1. Switching between locations can be a bit sticky, look for a change in the Inventory details dialog box to ensure that the tool has loaded the shelf
2. If you are attaching the barcode sticker at the same time, make sure the barcode sticker is on first and won’t fall off before you scan
3. There is no bulk function, but it can functionally be run in bulk by going shelf-by-shelf and attaching stickers and running updates
4. You need to have an internet connection for this to function because it works by
 - a. Accessing the ArchivesSpace API,
 - b. Downloading the location raw data via the location URI (you see it under the enable edit button),
 - c. Adding the barcode field with barcode number to the data,
 - d. Pushing the update back to ArchivesSpace,
 - e. Adding the barcode data to the location holdings report and saving it

Update location profile

Available space calculations in ArchivesSpace are based on accurate shelf dimension data. Inaccurate shelf data can lead to thinking there’s space available where there isn’t, or no space available where there is. Every shelf should have a location profile already, this is

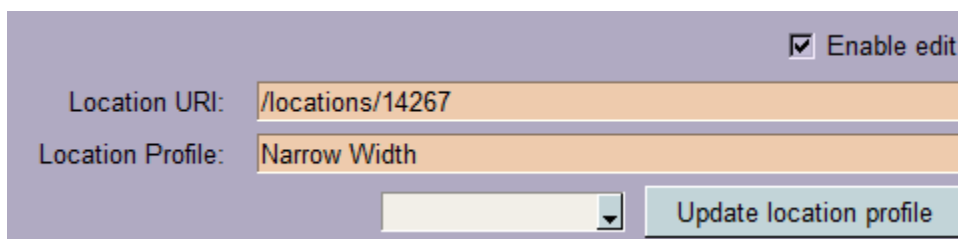
meant to allow users to correct mistakes in the assigned values. It is the only field that can have an existing value but still be updated.

First, you will need to follow the preliminary steps of:

1. Log into the ArchivesSpace API
2. Load/Reload the location holdings report spreadsheet
3. Check the Enable edit checkbox to reveal the update buttons

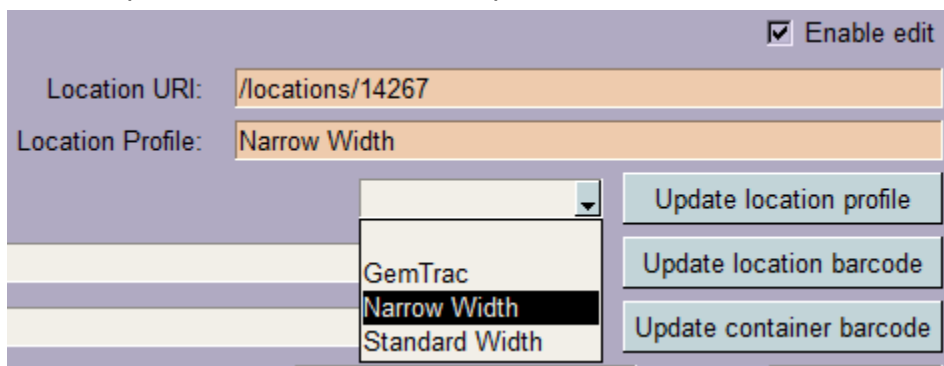
Now:

- Navigate to a specific location by either using the Filter by Location Coordinates or Filter by Location barcode functions
- You will see the location URI and currently assigned Location Profile immediately below the Enable edit checkbox



This screenshot shows a user interface for updating location profiles. At the top right, there is a checkbox labeled "Enable edit" which is checked. Below this, there are two input fields: "Location URI:" with the value "/locations/14267" and "Location Profile:" with the value "Narrow Width". To the right of the "Location Profile:" field is a small drop-down arrow. Below the drop-down arrow is a button labeled "Update location profile".

- Using the drop-down directly below the current Location Profile, select the correct location profile from the available options



This screenshot shows the same interface as the previous one, but with the drop-down menu open. The "Location URI:" field still contains "/locations/14267" and the "Location Profile:" field still contains "Narrow Width". The drop-down menu is open, showing three options: "GemTrac", "Narrow Width" (which is highlighted), and "Standard Width". To the right of the drop-down menu are three buttons: "Update location profile", "Update location barcode", and "Update container barcode".

- Click on Update location profile to apply the change
- Once the update action has been completed you will get an "update completed" message in the General Dialog box.

Notes about updating location profiles

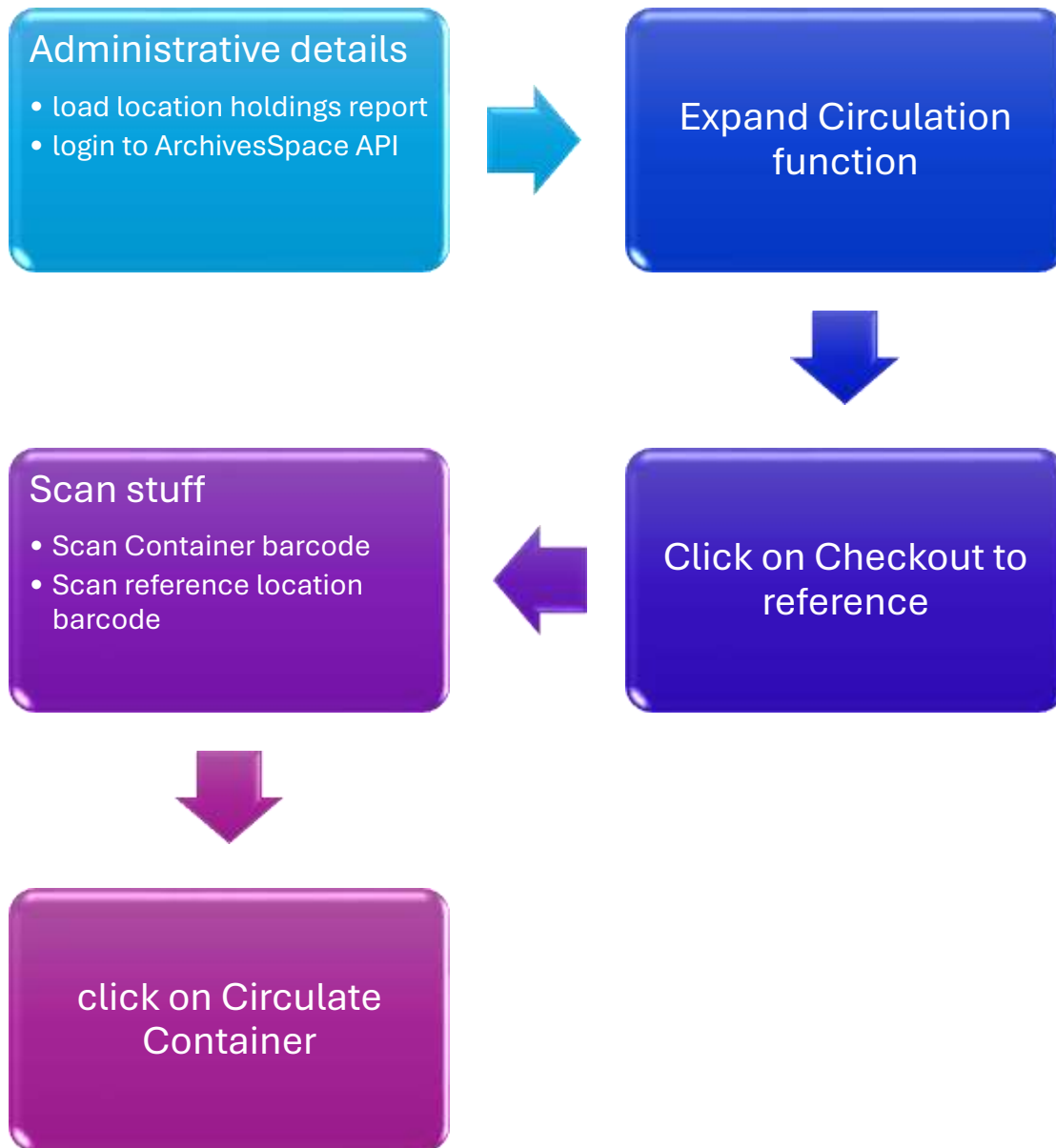
1. A safeguard is in place to prevent trying to update the location profile to the same value
2. Only the most common location profiles are in the inventory tool, with the following dimensions
 - a. Narrow width = 24 linear inches wide

- b. Standard width = 36 linear inches wide
- 3. Any other location profiles will need to be added manually in ArchivesSpace
- 4. You need to have an internet connection for this to work as it does these steps
 - a. Accessing the ArchivesSpace API,
 - b. Downloading the location raw data via the location URI (you see it under the enable edit button),
 - c. Replacing the existing URI for location profile with the URI associated with the selected location profile,
 - d. Pushing the update back to ArchivesSpace,
 - e. Updating the location profile field in the location holdings report and saving it
- 5. Be aware that a location profile does not need to make sense relative to the contents of the location. For example, a volume has a default width that is never accurate but an average. A whole lot of small volumes can fit on a Narrow width shelf even though in ArchivesSpace the average width would make that far wider than a Standard width shelf. This is not inherently a bad thing, but does mean there are no safeguards to prevent changing the size of a shelf to be too narrow to fit the containers associated with it.

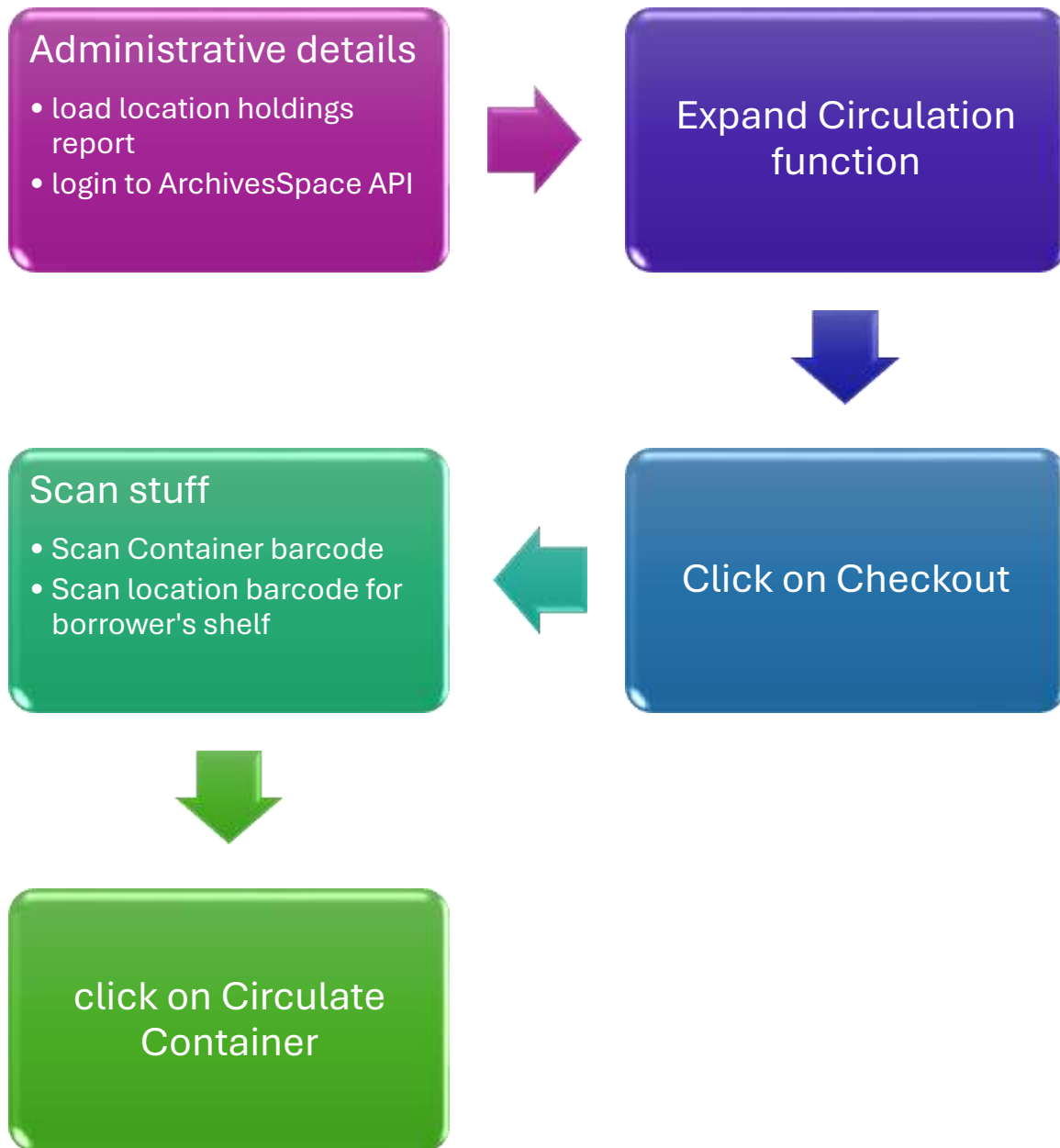
Rough Workflows

The following rough workflows apply to the anticipated use of this tool.

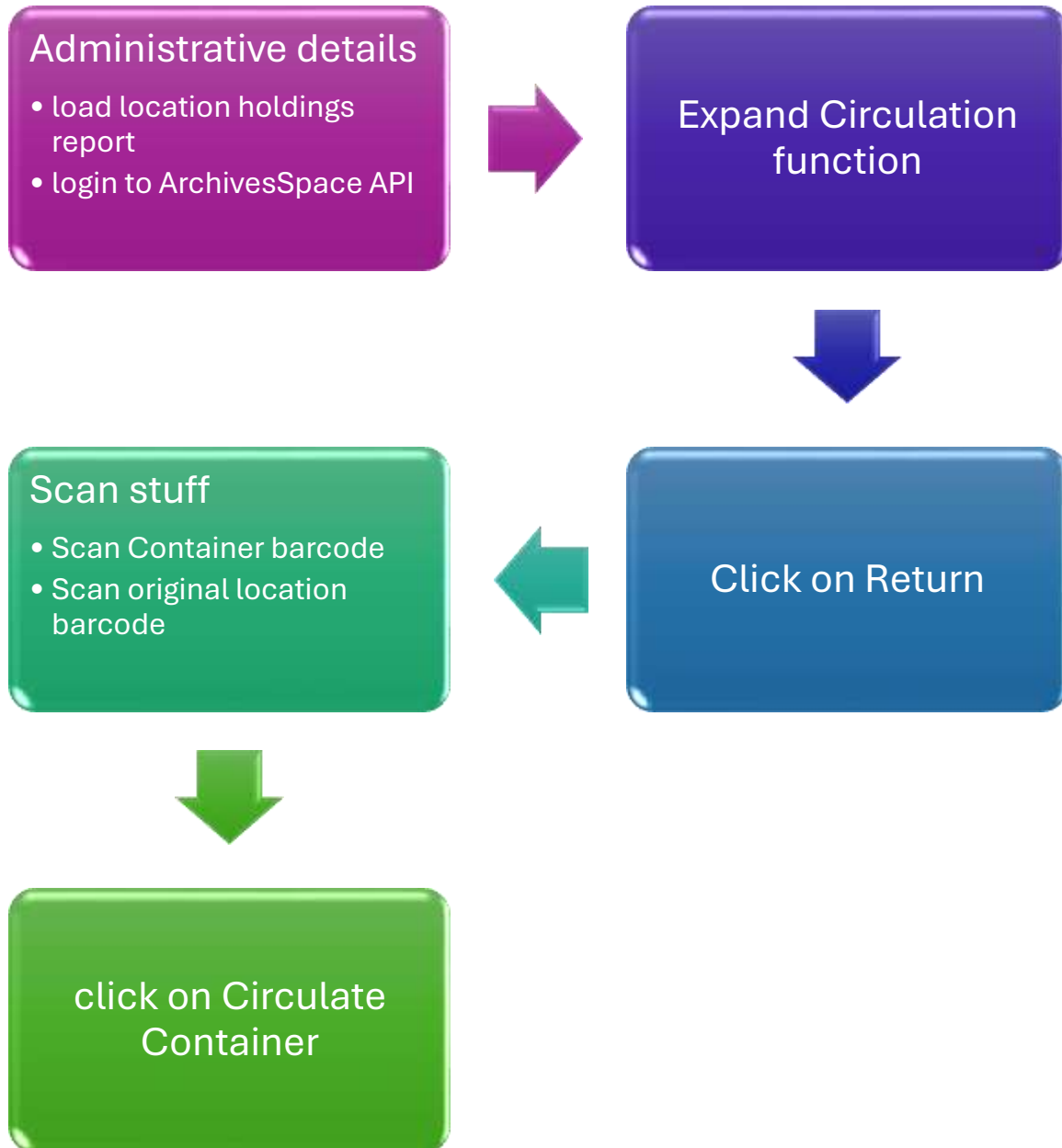
Checkout a container to reference for a patron



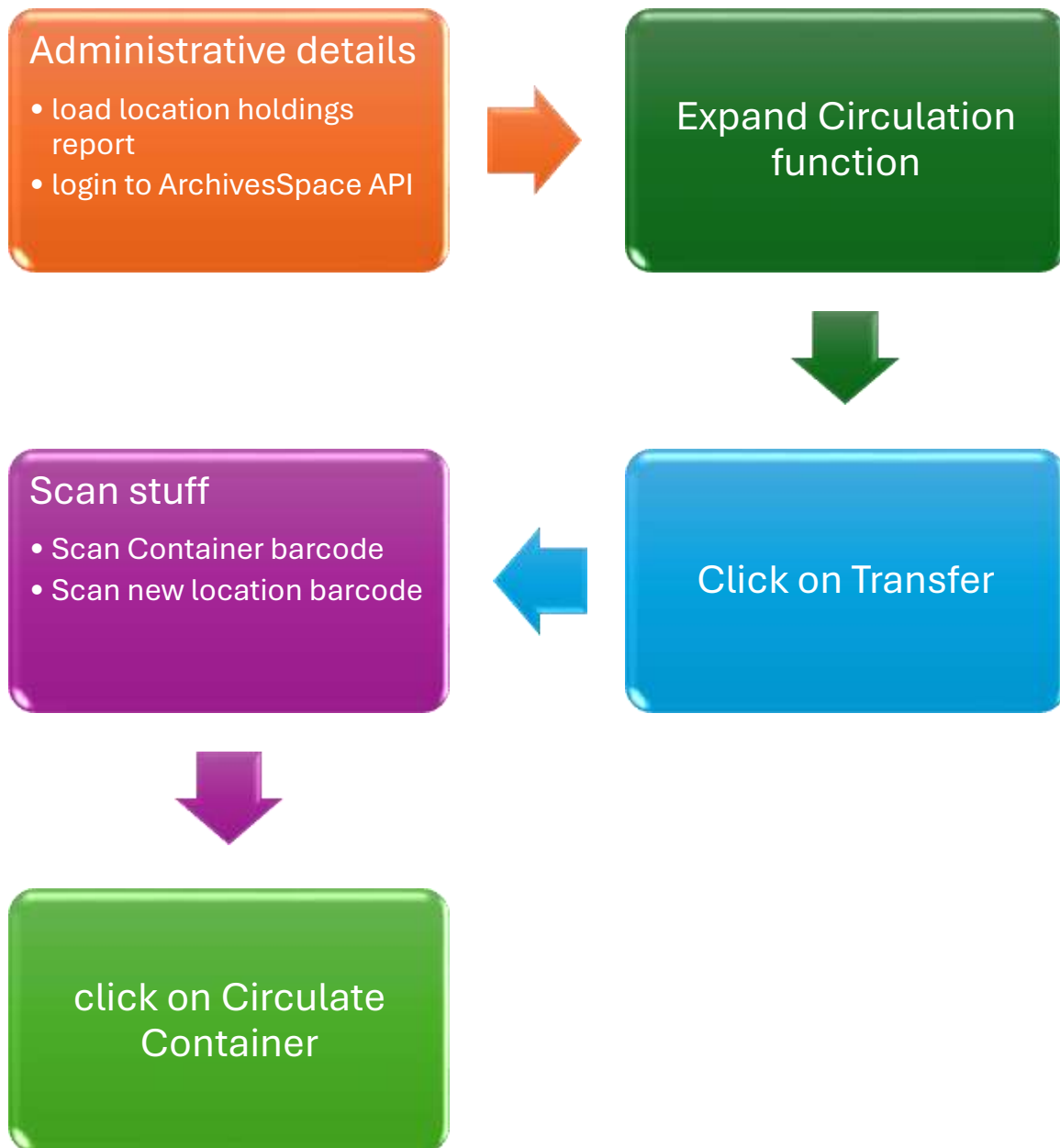
Checkout a container to someone else



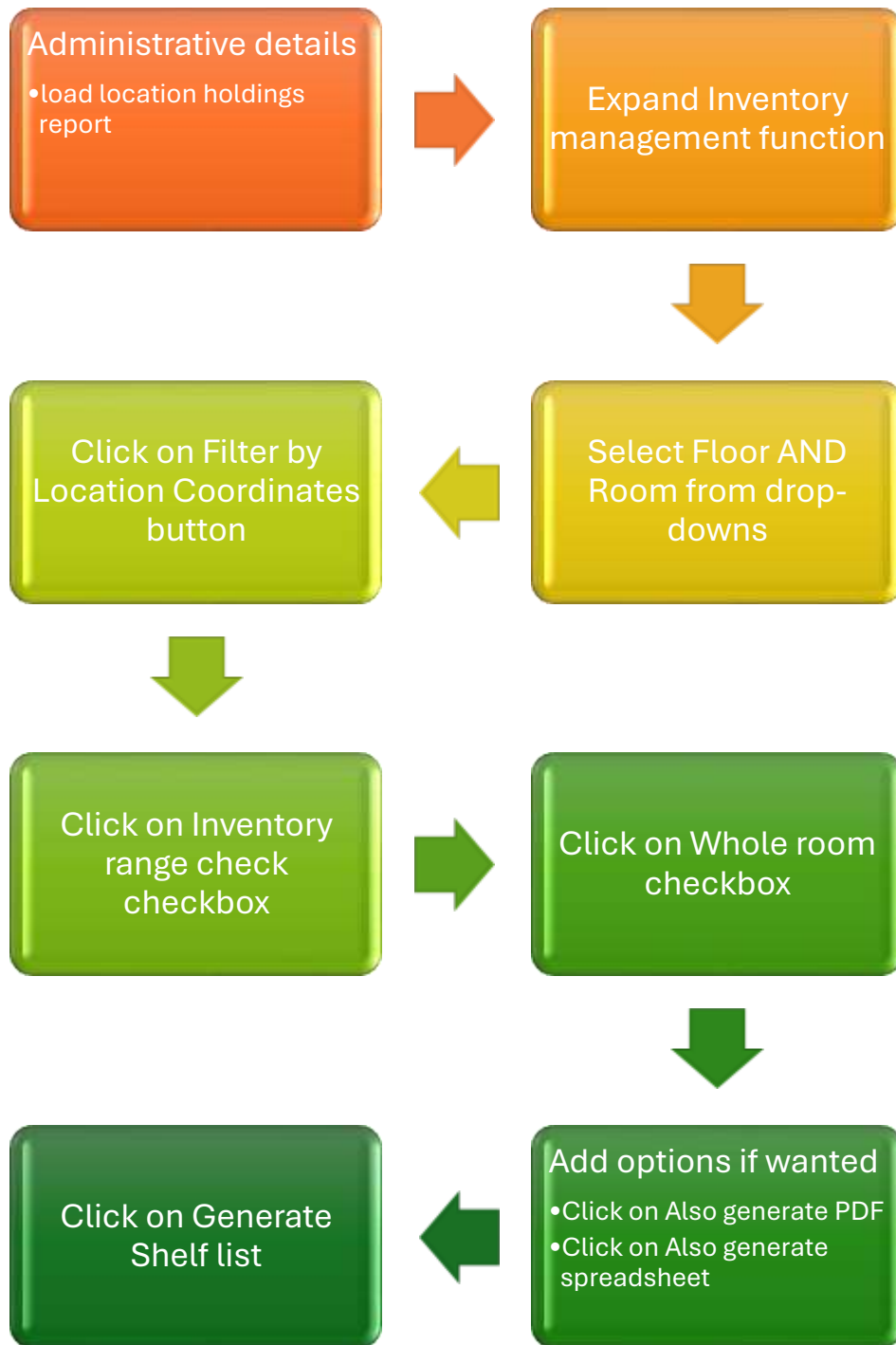
Send something back to the stacks



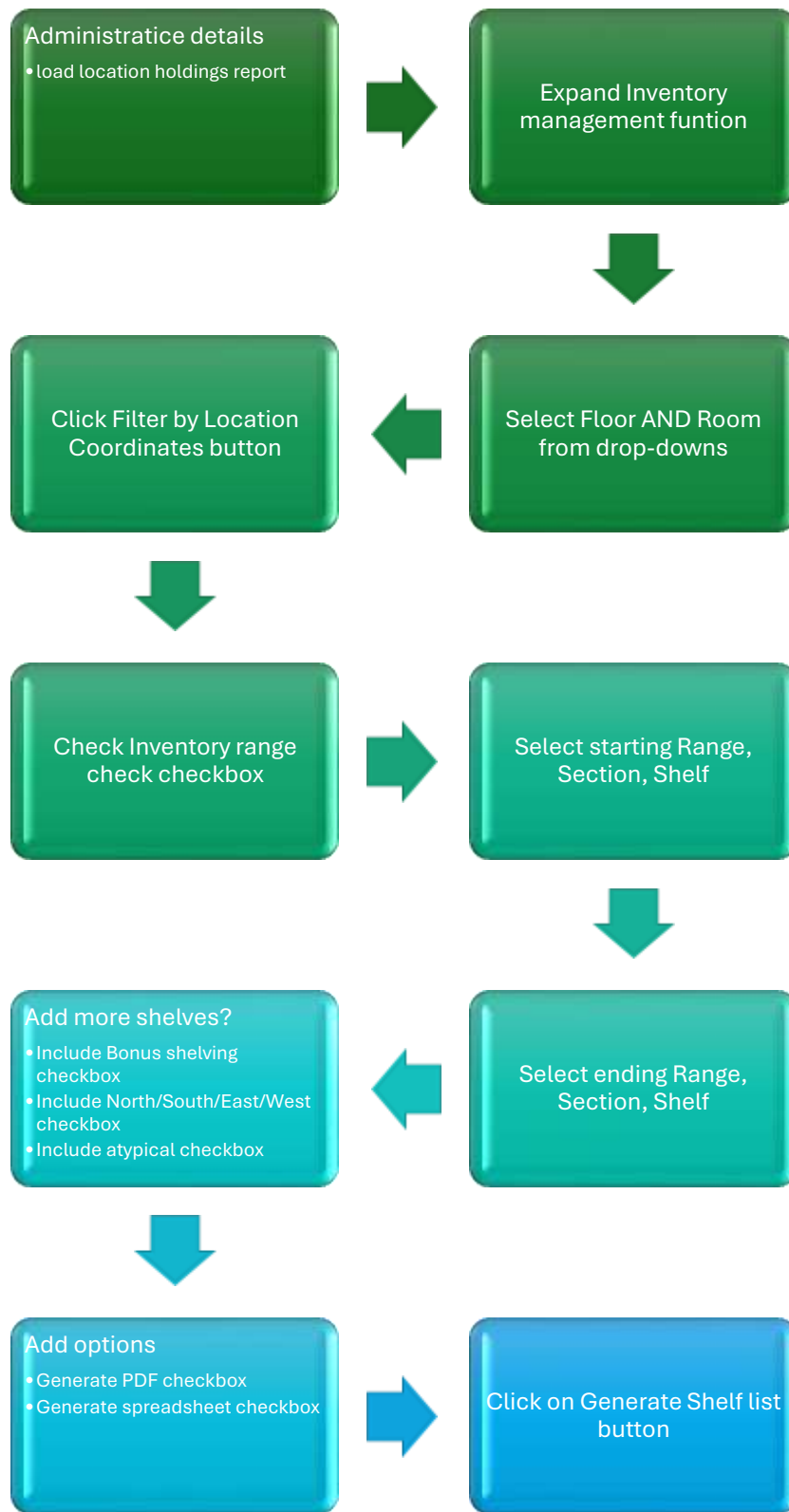
Move something to a different stacks location



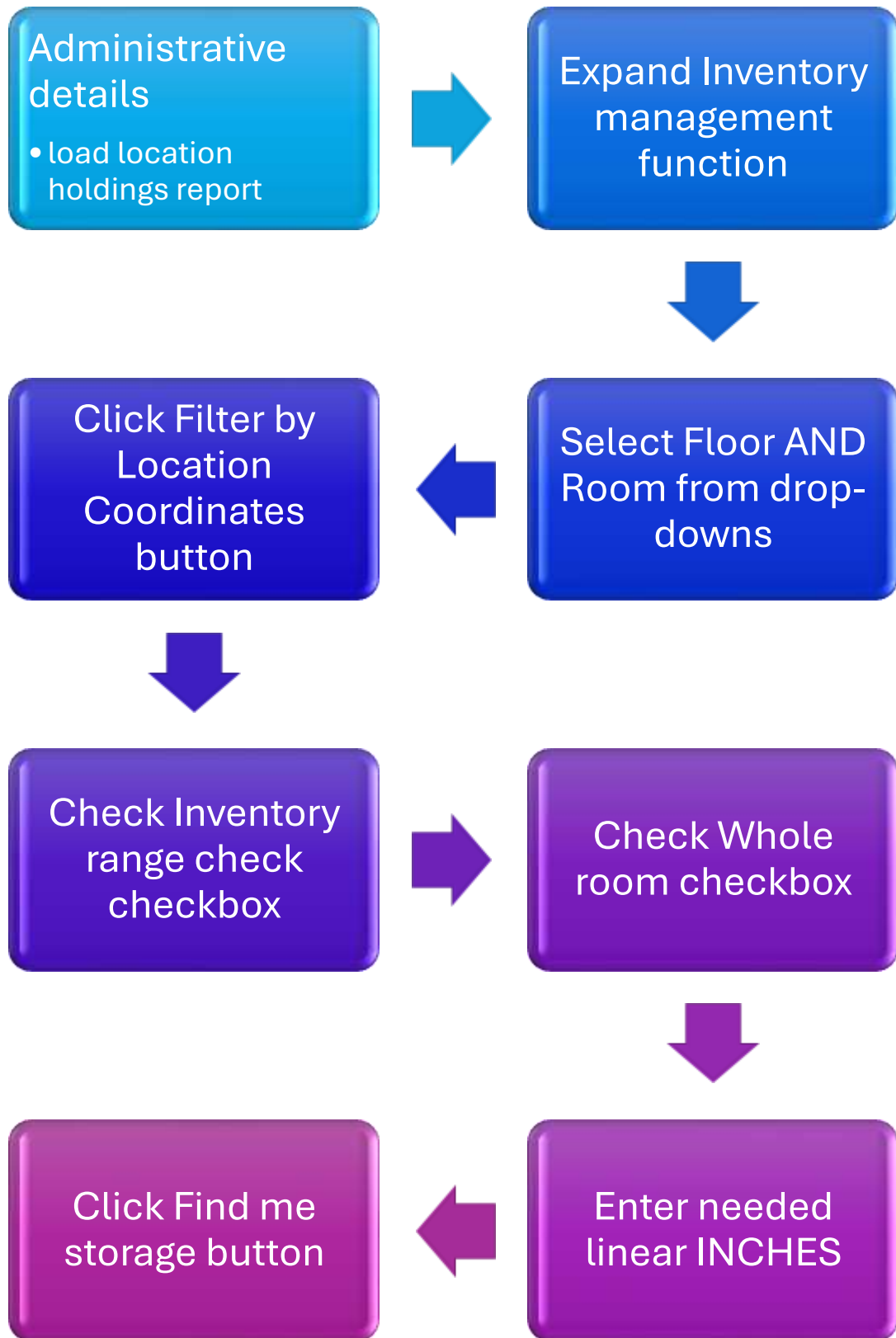
Generate a shelf-list for an entire stack/room



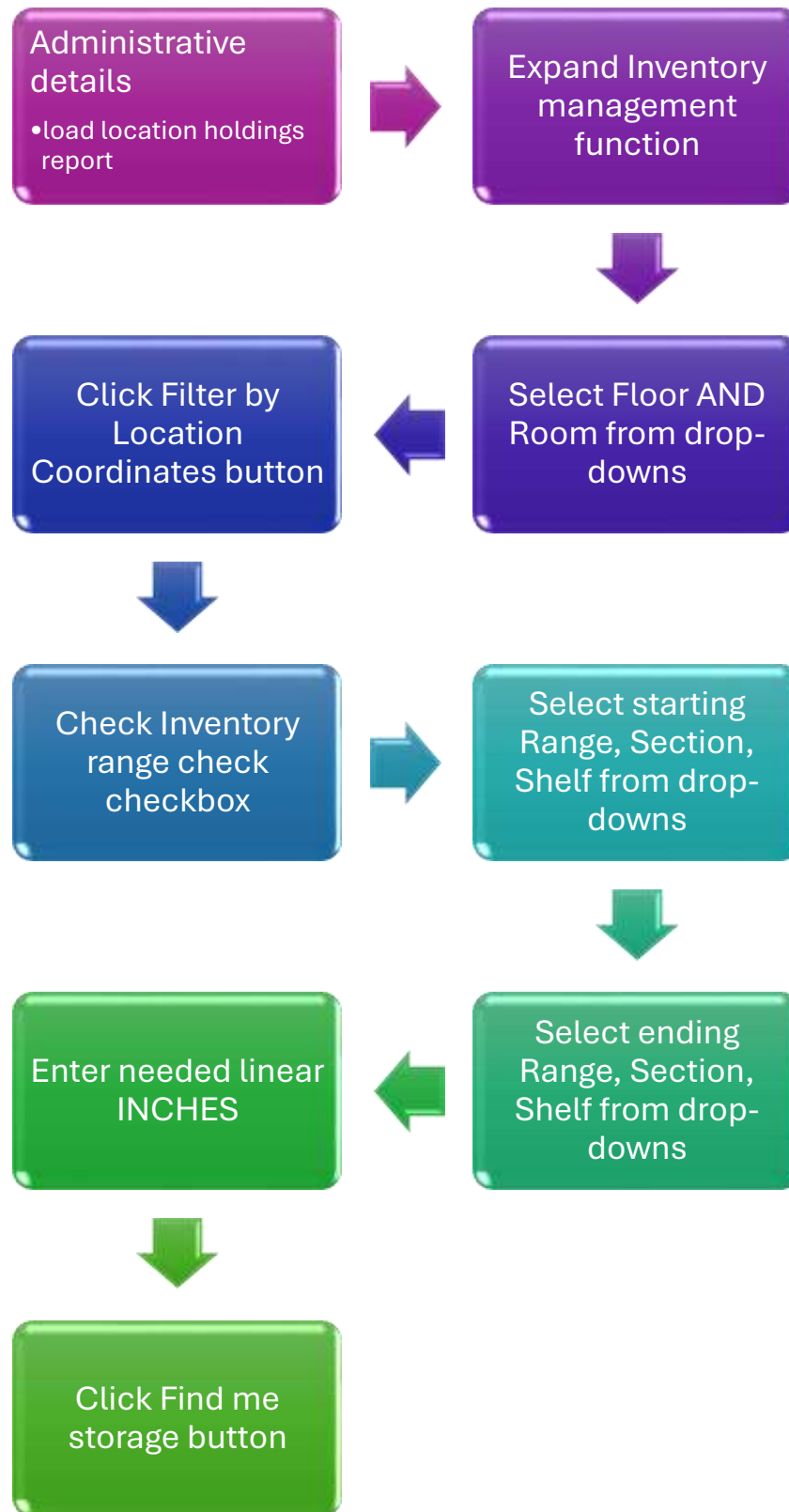
Generate a shelf list for a part of a room



Find available space in a room



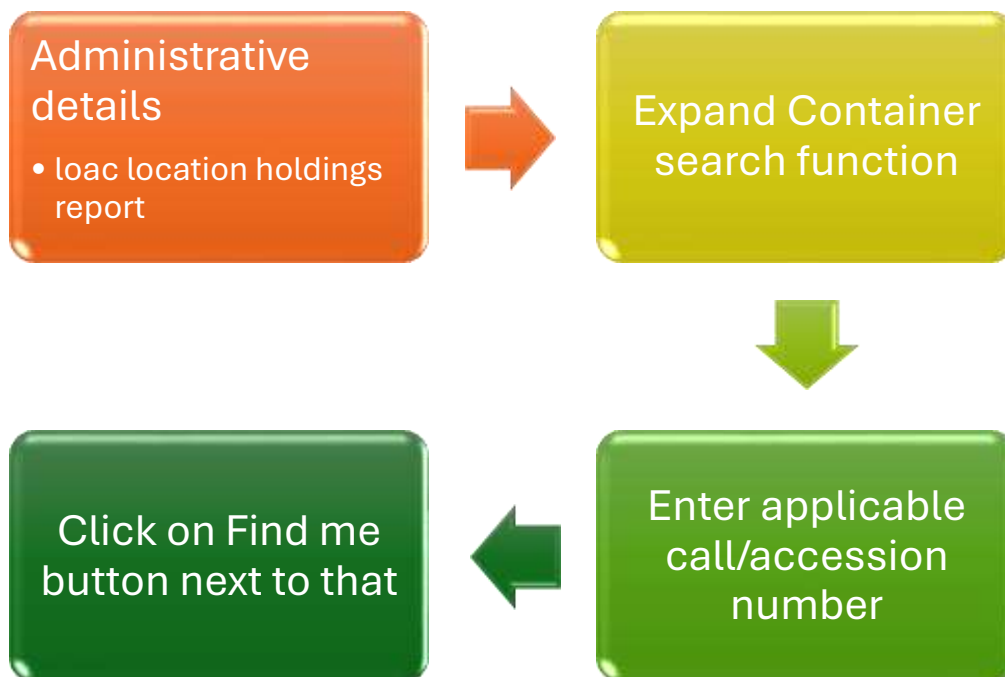
Find available space in a part of a room



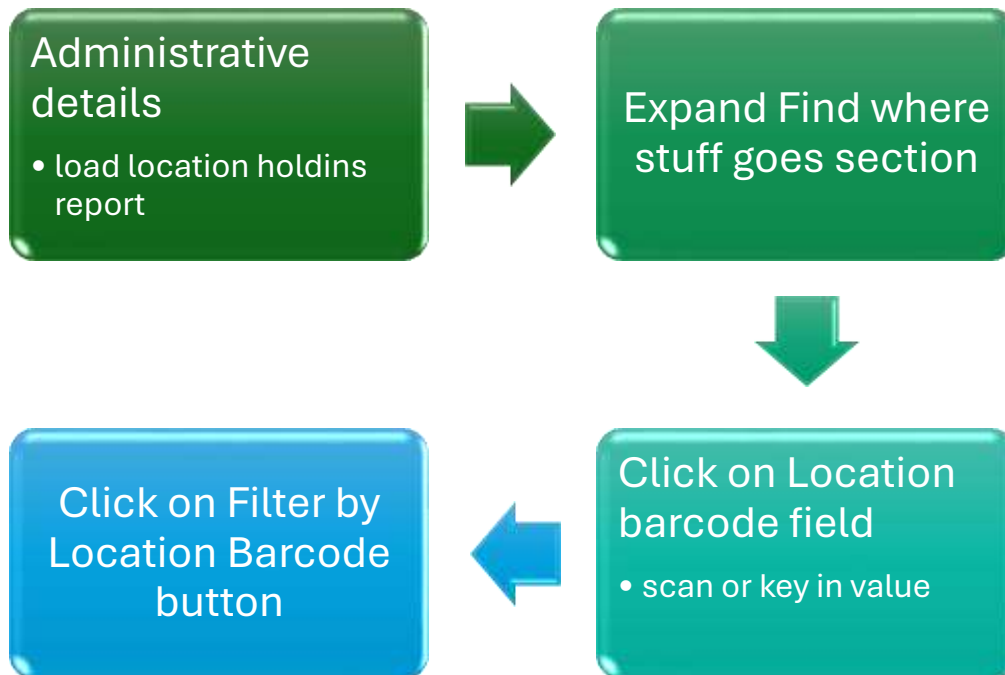
Create an inventory to check for a “finished” finding aid



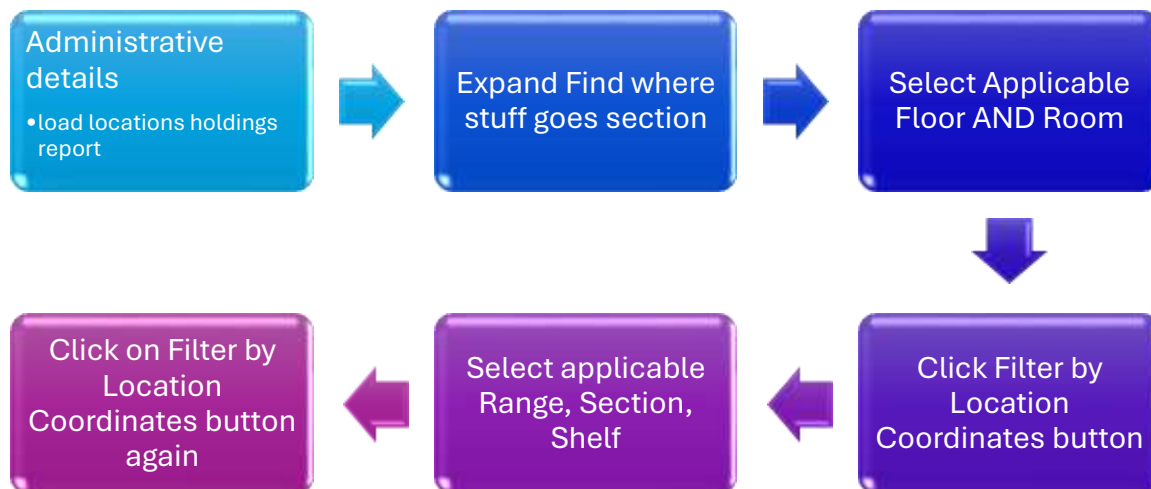
Create an inventory to check against an accession/call number



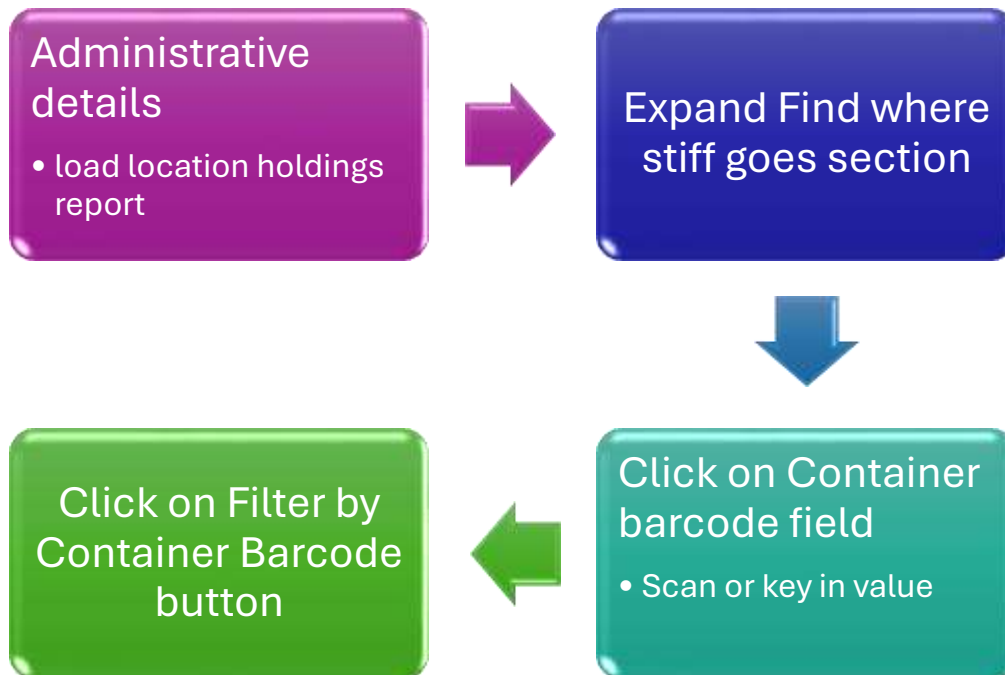
Find out what is on a shelf using a barcode



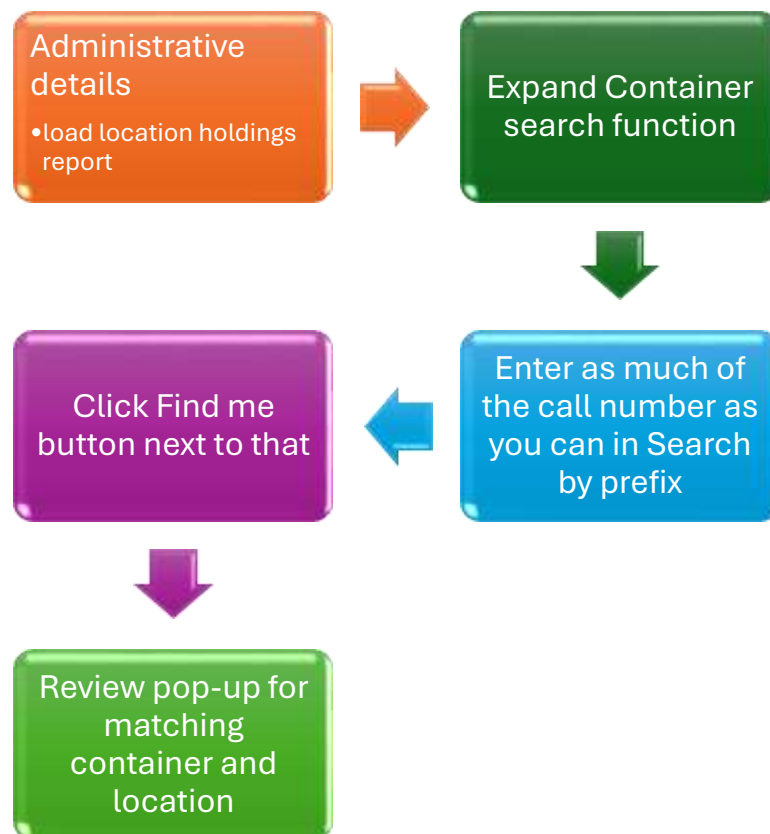
Find out what is on a shelf using stacks coordinates



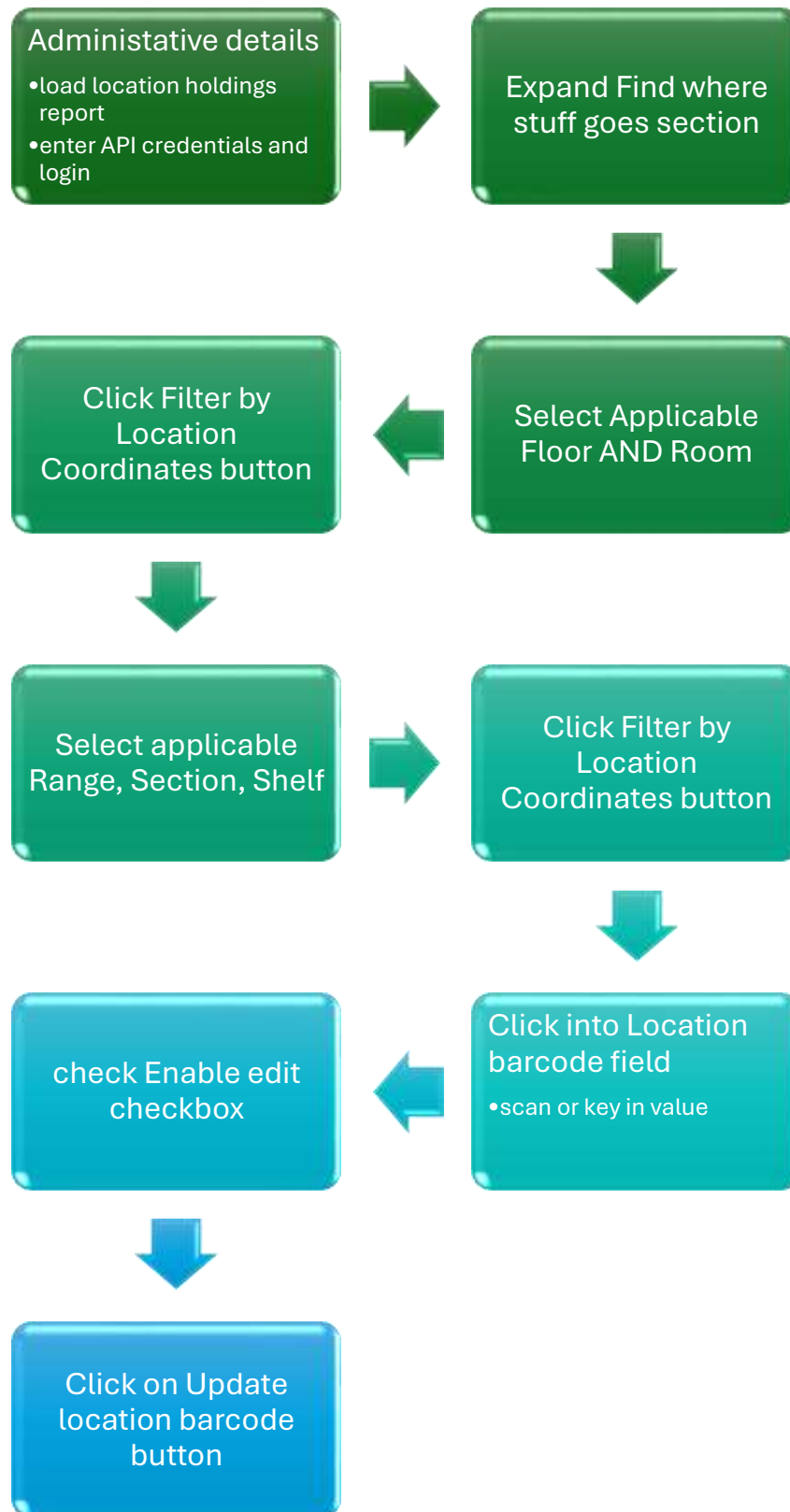
Find out where something goes using a barcode



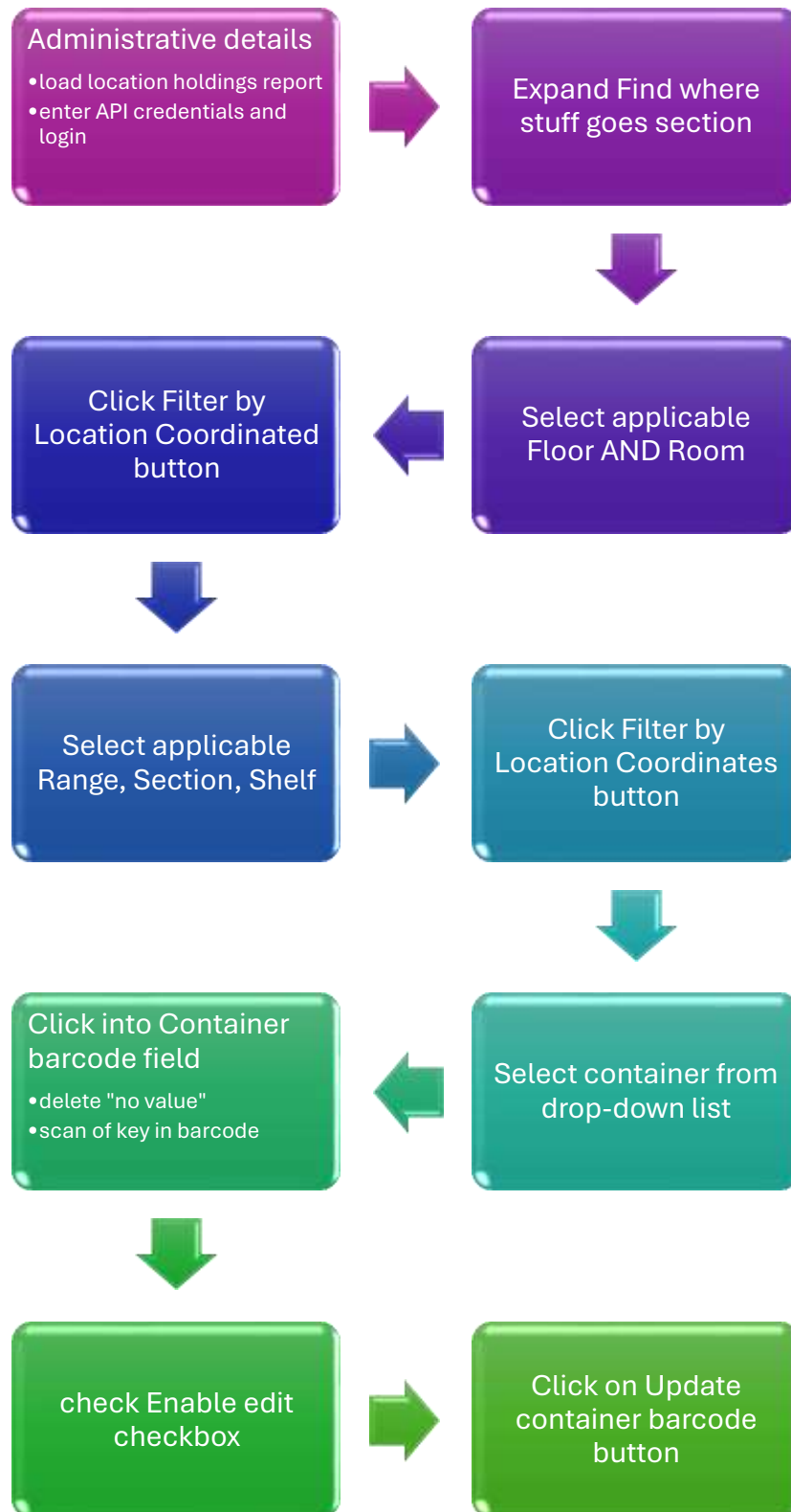
Find out where something goes using a call number



Add a barcode to a location



Add a barcode to a container



Update a location profile

